

Google Sheets Registration Sync — Setup Guide

Event Management System

Part 1 — One-time Google Cloud setup

1. Create a Google Cloud project

Go to `console.cloud.google.com` ? project dropdown (top-left) ? **New Project** ? name it (e.g. `event-management-sheets`) ? Create.

2. Enable the Sheets API

Go to `console.cloud.google.com/apis/library/sheets.googleapis.com` ? click **Enable**.

3. Create a service account

Go to `console.cloud.google.com/iam-admin/serviceaccounts` ? **Create Service Account** ? name it (e.g. `sheets-sync`) ? Create and Continue ? skip the optional role/access steps ? **Done**.

4. Generate its key

Click into the service account ? **Keys** tab ? **Add Key** ? **Create new key** ? **JSON** ? Create. A `.json` file downloads — keep it outside the repo, never commit it.

Part 2 — One-time app configuration

5. Convert the key into .env format

Run locally, in PowerShell (keeps the private key off the clipboard history / any chat):

```
$json = Get-Content "C:\path\to\your-downloaded-key.json" -Raw | ConvertFrom-Json
Write-Output "GOOGLE_SHEETS_CLIENT_EMAIL=$( $json.client_email )"
Write-Output "GOOGLE_SHEETS_PRIVATE_KEY='$( $json.private_key -replace "`n", '\n' )'"
```

6. Paste both lines into .env

Replace the blank `GOOGLE_SHEETS_CLIENT_EMAIL=` / `GOOGLE_SHEETS_PRIVATE_KEY=` lines already there, then run:

```
php artisan config:clear
```

This is app-wide — done once, works for every event.

Part 3 — Per-event setup (repeat for each event)

7. Create or open the Google Sheet

The sheet you want that event's registrations to flow into — a new blank sheet at `sheets.google.com`, or an existing one someone else made.

8. Share it with the service account

1. Top-right **Share** button on the sheet
2. Paste the `client_email` address from step 5 (looks like `sheets-sync@your-project.iam.gserviceaccount.com`)
3. Set role to **Editor** ? Send

Without this exact step, every sync fails with a 403 "denied access" error — sharing the sheet is what actually grants the app write access.

9. Link the sheet to the event

1. In the app: **Events** ? **[your event]** ? **Edit**
2. Paste the sheet's URL into **"Google Sheet URL"** (under Event Details) ? Save

The helper text under that field shows the service account email again, in case you need to re-check what to share with.

Part 4 — Using it

10. Sync registrations

1. Go to **Registrations** (make sure the correct event is active in the sidebar switcher)
2. Click **Update Spreadsheet**
3. First click: writes the header row, then appends every current registrant
4. Every click after: appends only registrants added since the last sync — rows already in the sheet, and anything typed/colored into them, are never touched

11. What the notification tells you

- **"Appended N new registrant(s)"** — success
- **"Nothing new to sync"** — no new registrants since last click, nothing was sent
- **"No active event selected"** — pick an event in the sidebar first
- **"Spreadsheet sync failed: Google denied access..."** — the sheet wasn't shared with the service account (redo step 8), or the wrong URL was pasted (redo step 9)

Handing this off to someone else

- Steps 1–6 only need doing once per deployment, by whoever manages the Google Cloud project.
- Steps 7–9 are what an event organizer does per event — no code or console access needed, just Google Sheets sharing and the Event edit form.
- Whoever works in the sheet afterward (coloring rows, adding remarks) never needs to touch the app at all.